DGFT Market Access Initiative (MAI) Scheme for MSME Exporters

Issuing Authority: Directorate General of Foreign Trade, Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Govt. of India

1. Focus on Export Market Penetration

The Market Access Initiative (MAI) Scheme, administered by the Department of Commerce and DGFT, provides financial assistance to micro, small, and medium exporters to access new global markets, participate in international exhibitions, and conduct statutory quality certifications in importing countries.

2. Airfare and Exhibition Stall Subsidies

Eligible micro and small exporters receive:

• Stall Rental Subsidy: Up to Rs. 3 Lakhs or 60% of stall rental charges (75% for SC/ST/Women entrepreneurs and exporters from NER) for participating in approved overseas trade fairs.

• Airfare Assistance: Reimbursement of economy class airfare up to Rs. 1.25 Lakhs per exporter.

• Buyer-Seller Meets (BSM): 100% subsidized participation in international B2B buyer-seller meets organized by Export Promotion Councils.

3. Statutory Compliance and Quality Certification Reimbursement

Financial assistance up to 50% of the cost (maximum Rs. 15 Lakhs per enterprise) for obtaining mandatory overseas certifications (US-FDA, CE marking, REACH, GMP, Halal, Kosher) required for exporting goods to US, European, and Middle Eastern markets.

4. Application via DGFT and EPC Portals

Exporters possessing an active Import-Export Code (IEC) and valid Udyam Registration submit applications through their registered Export Promotion Council (EEPC, FIEO, CLE, APEDA) on dgft.gov.in.